

What we fixed after the last defense

Ten contracts staged in the live system, each one there to show a single change the panel asked for. Four improvements, demonstrated in the order they make sense to explain: logistics readiness, the payment deadline, the write-off warning, and rent versus buy.

10 contracts 4 procurement requests 29 notifications 4 improvements

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Setting up, and what to say first

OPENING LINE

Last time, the panel gave us four comments. We went back and worked on all four. What I have here are ten contracts we set up in the system — each one exists to show exactly one of those fixes, so nothing here is a mock-up. Every alert you'll see was generated by the system itself when we seeded the data.

Run `npm run seed:redense` before you start. It clears its own records, rebuilds all ten contracts, and then runs the real payment-compliance and loading-readiness sweeps — so the notifications are already sitting in the right inboxes. Every record is prefixed `RD-` so it is obvious on screen which data belongs to this demo. Dates are relative to the day you seed, so "two days out" stays true tomorrow.

LOG IN AS	ACCOUNT	WHAT IS WAITING
Accounting	accounting@juancarlos.com	11 alerts — deadlines, write-off, rent vs buy
Logistics	logistics@juancarlos.com	7 alerts — loading readiness
Purchasing	purchasing@juancarlos.com	Rent-vs-buy comparison on the queue
Kitchen	kitchen@juancarlos.com	2 alerts — holding up a truck
Linen	linen@juancarlos.com	2 alerts — holding up a truck

DO THIS LAST, RIGHT BEFORE YOU PRESENT

Run the seed again in the hour before you start. Every date is calculated from the moment you seed, so "two days out" and "tomorrow" are only guaranteed correct for a fresh run. If you seeded yesterday, `RD-LOAD-LINEN` slides from the two-day warning into the one-day at-risk tier and the wording on screen will not match this script.

If anything looks wrong mid-demo, re-run the seed and restart the backend — the sweeps also run on server start, so a restart regenerates every alert. Day counts inside alert titles ("after N days") move with the calendar; this script writes them as N rather than a fixed number for that reason.

"Does it show if the trucks are ready for loading?"

SAY THIS BEFORE YOU CLICK ANYTHING

So sir, your comment was that the load manifest shows what to bring, but it doesn't say whether the trucks are actually ready to load. When we went back to the code, we found something worse than that. The dashboard's next-step message was computed from only two things — how many days until the event, and whether a truck was booked. It knew nothing at all about whether anything was prepared.

Which meant on the night before an event where the linen hadn't been washed, it would still say "confirm loading." So we fixed the signal, not just the display.

Log in as `logistics@juancarlos.com` and open the **Logistics Dashboard**. Two new cards sit at the top: **Ready To Load** and **Not Ready**. Show those first, then walk the three contracts below in order — they go good, then warning, then critical.

The situation these three come from. All three were booked around four months ago and paid in full a month later, so nothing financial is in the way. They are approved, staffed, and in preparation. The only thing that differs between them is how far each department has got with its own items — which, before this change, was information the logistics screen never looked at.

RD-LOAD-GO RD Navarro Garden Wedding		in 2 days · 180 pax
BACK STORY	Booked four months ago, paid in full a month later. Nothing went wrong on this one — Kitchen prepared the ingredients, Stockroom did the chafing dishes and cocktail tables, Linen did the tablecloths and napkins, Creative finished the floral arch. Every department marked its own items as they went. This is the control case: what a clean event looks like.	
SHOWS	Ready	All four departments have finished. This is what a clear event looks like.
DO THIS	On the dashboard the row carries a green Ready to load badge. Open the contract → Logistics tab → Load & Dispatch (info) sub-tab. A green banner sits above the manifest: <i>"Ready for loading — 4 of 4 department(s) ready"</i> , with Kitchen, Stockroom, Linen and Creative each listed as Prepared.	
SAY	"This is the one that's fine. All four departments finished, so the system cleared it — and it says which four, so nobody has to take that on trust."	
BACKED BY	Cleared for loading: RD-LOAD-GO	sent to Logistics when the last department finished.

RD-LOAD-LINEN RD Espinosa Corporate Dinner		in 2 days · 150 pax
BACK STORY	Booked and paid exactly like the one above. Kitchen, Stockroom and Creative all finished. Linen got through the 18 tablecloths but the 150 chair sashes are still pending — they are washed but not counted and marked. Nothing is wrong with this event; one department is simply a day behind on one line item. That is the whole point: it is a small gap, and before this change nobody would have found it until the truck was being loaded.	
SHOWS	Chase Loading starts tomorrow and one department is behind. The system names <i>who</i> .	
DO THIS	Click the new Not Ready tab. The row reads 3/4 ready and the next step says " <i>Follow up with Linen before loading</i> ", with the outstanding count. The chair sashes are still pending; the tablecloths are done.	
SAY	"Before, this row would have just said 'confirm loading.' Now it tells me it's Linen, and it tells me how many items. That's the difference between a status and a decision — I know who to call."	
BACKED BY	Not ready for loading: RD-LOAD-LINEN to Logistics, and separately Prepare items before loading starts: RD-LOAD-LINEN to Linen — with a link to their own screen.	

RD-LOAD-RISK RD Villamor Debut		tomorrow · 200 pax
BACK STORY	Same clean booking, paid in full months ago. Stockroom, Linen and Creative are all done. The Kitchen sourced its ingredients but has not prepared them — their status is still "procured". The event is tomorrow, so loading should already be under way. This is the one that would actually have gone wrong: a truck arriving to load an event where the food is not ready.	
SHOWS	At risk The loading window is already open and the Kitchen has not finished. This is the escalation tier.	
DO THIS	Same tab, red badge. The next step reads " Event at risk — chase Kitchen " and names what is outstanding: ingredients sourced but not prepared yet. Then log in as <code>kitchen@juancarlos.com</code> and show that they were told directly.	
SAY	"And this is the one I'd actually be worried about. It's tomorrow, loading should already be happening, and the kitchen isn't done. Both sides got told — logistics knows it's at risk, and the kitchen knows they're the ones holding up a truck."	
BACKED BY	Loading window open – event not ready: RD-LOAD-RISK to Logistics, Loading is waiting on Kitchen: RD-LOAD-RISK to Kitchen.	
IF ASKED	Why not just alert when everything is ready? — "An event that's ready doesn't need a decision; nobody agonises over the one that's fine. And if we only sent the good news, silence would be ambiguous — you wouldn't know if it meant not ready, or nobody updated the record. So the escalation is the main feature and the clearance is secondary."	

"Until when can the client pay the remaining 60%?"

SAY THIS FIRST – IT'S AN HONEST ADMISSION

When this was asked, we went to check our own business rules, and the honest answer was that we didn't have one. A contract could sit on payment hold forever and nothing would ever happen to it. The date stayed blocked, nobody chased it, and the event just quietly sat there. So we added the rule: the balance has to be settled one month before the event. Past that, the system cancels the booking and releases the date.

Log in as `accounting@juancarlos.com`. These two contracts are the same story at two different points on the timeline — one still inside the deadline, one past it. Both clients did the same thing: paid the reservation and the 40% on time, then went quiet when the balance came due.

RD-HOLD-WARN	RD Sandoval Silver Anniversary	on hold · 240 pax
BACK STORY	Booked six months ago for a 240-pax anniversary. The client paid the 40% of ₱211,200.00 on the exact day it fell due — a good client, no red flags. Then the 60% became due two months before the event and nothing arrived. The system placed the contract on hold by itself, and it has sat there for more than three weeks . Preparation is blocked, the date is still reserved, and until this change that is where it would have stayed indefinitely.	
SHOWS	3 days left	The last-chance notice before a booking is cancelled.
NUMBERS	Contract ₱528,000.00 · paid ₱211,200.00 · ₱316,800.00 outstanding · settlement deadline is 3 days away (one month before the event).	
DO THIS	Open the contract → Payments tab. The settlement deadline is now shown there and on the printed contract. Then show the alert: the action button reads Contact customer , not "review payment" — because at three days out, the action is a phone call.	
SAY	"It's been on hold for over three weeks now. Accounting has been getting a weekly reminder that whole time, and now that it's three days from the deadline, the message changes — it stops being a reminder and becomes a last chance."	
BACKED BY	Final notice – N day(s) to settle: RD-HOLD-WARN	and the weekly Still on hold after N days: RD-HOLD-WARN .

RD-HOLD-LAPSE RD Bautista Corporate Gala		cancelled · 300 pax
BACK STORY	The same story, one month further along. Booked seven months ago, 40% of ₱264,000.00 paid on time, then silence when the 60% fell due. Hold placed automatically two days after the due date. Accounting chased it weekly for a month; nothing came back. The settlement deadline passed a few days ago , and the sweep cancelled the booking. This is the contract that shows what the system did not have before — an ending.	
SHOWS	Cancelled Nobody cancelled this. The sweep did, and it explained itself.	
NUMBERS	Contract ₱660,000.00 · paid ₱264,000.00 · ₱396,000.00 was never settled · deadline passed several days ago .	
DO THIS	Open it — the status reads Cancelled . Scroll to the internal notes: the system wrote the reason and the date it acted. Then show the two alerts it sent.	
SAY	"Nobody touched this contract. The sweep found it past the deadline and cancelled it, and then it did two things — it told Accounting and Sales to contact the customer, and it told every operations department to release whatever they'd reserved. Because a cancelled date is still holding stock and staff unless somebody says otherwise."	
BACKED BY	Contract cancelled – final balance not settled: RD-HOLD-LAPSE to Accounting, Sales and Admin · Contract cancelled – release resources: RD-HOLD-LAPSE to Kitchen, Linen, Creative, Stockroom and Logistics.	
ALSO SAY	"One thing we kept on purpose — if management has put an override on a contract, the sweep leaves it alone. We didn't want the system overruling a person who'd already made a decision about a specific client."	

"Add more notifications before an account is written off"

SAY THIS

The panel asked us to add more steps between the 40% follow-up and marking an account uncollectible. When we mapped it out, there was one real gap: the account got a weekly reminder, and then on day 30 it was just written off. No last warning.

I should also correct something we assumed. We thought the 60% had no advance warning either — it turned out it already did, we just hadn't found it in the code. So we only added the one that was genuinely missing.

RD-AGING-LAST RD Delgado Christening		40% unpaid · 120 pax
BACK STORY	A different failure from the two before it. This client signed three months ago for a christening next March — and then never paid anything at all , not even the 40%. The collection fell due two months after booking and has been outstanding ever since. Accounting has had the follow-up, the due-date task, and four weekly reminders. It is now 28 days overdue, and on day 30 the account is written off.	
SHOWS	Last chance The new warning, three days before the aging window closes.	
NUMBERS	Contract ₱264,000.00 · 40% collection of ₱105,600.00 never received · 28 days overdue · the aging window is about to close.	
DO THIS	As Accounting, show the three alerts on this contract in order — the follow-up, the due-date task, and now the final notice. Point out the action button says Contact customer .	
SAY	"So the ladder is now: a heads-up a month before it's due, the task on the due date, weekly reminders while it's overdue, then this — three days before we write it off. And the weekly reminder stops once this fires, so the last three days aren't sending two messages that say the same thing."	
BACKED BY	Final notice - N days before write-off: RD-AGING-LAST — new. Alongside the existing Start 40% collection follow-up and 40% collection task .	

STAGE	40% COLLECTION	60% FINAL BALANCE
Advance warning	1 month before due	1 month before due
Due date	Collection task	Hold placed automatically
Recurring	Weekly while unpaid	Weekly while held
Final notice	3 days before write-off — new	3 days before cancellation — new
End state	Account uncollectible	Contract cancelled, resources released

Both ladders now end the same way: a warning, then the terminal state. Neither arrives without notice.

"If two events rent the same thing, shouldn't we just buy it?"

SAY THIS BEFORE OPENING ANYTHING

This one we found interesting, because the obvious answer is wrong. Yes — if two events rent the same tent on different dates, one tent covers both, so buying can be cheaper. But if the two events are on the *same day*, buying one tent solves nothing. You'd still need two.

So instead of counting requests, the system works out the peak number of units you'd actually need at any one moment, and compares against that. We staged both cases so you can see it give opposite answers.

Log in as `accounting@juancarlos.com` → **Procurement Approval** → **Budget Approval Queue**. Both pairs are in the same queue. The same panel also appears for Purchasing under **Waiting Budget Approval**.

Where these four came from. All four events are fully paid and in preparation — there is no payment problem here. What they have in common is that each one needs a piece of equipment Juan Carlo does not own, so Stockroom raised a rental request against the contract. Four contracts, four rental requests, two items. The requests were entered on different days by the same department, and until this change each one arrived at Accounting as an isolated approval with no reference to the other.

RD-PR-RENT-SEP-A & -B Marquee Tent — separate dates		six weeks apart
BACK STORY	Two garden weddings booked by different sales staff, six weeks apart. Both venues need a marquee, and Juan Carlo doesn't own one — so Stockroom raised a rental request against each contract, at ₱11,500.00 a time. Two separate requests, entered weeks apart, sitting in the same approval queue. Nothing connected them, and whoever approved the second one had no way of knowing they had already approved the first.	
SHOWS	Buying wins	Two events, six weeks apart, same tent.
NUMBERS	Rent twice ₱23,000.00 · buy 1 unit ₱18,000.00 · indicative saving ₱5,000.00.	
DO THIS	Open either request. A green panel reads " Same item requested elsewhere — Buying looks cheaper ", with three tiles: rent all, buy, saving. Underneath, "Also requested by" names the other request and its event date.	
SAY	"These two are six weeks apart, so one tent covers both. The system worked that out and it's telling Accounting before they approve either one — because approving a rental is what commits the money."	
BACKED BY	Consider buying instead of renting: RD Marquee Tent 10x20m	sent to Accounting, Purchasing and Admin.

RD-PR-RENT-DAY-A & -B Stage Riser — same day		both on one day
BACK STORY	A product launch and an awards night that both landed on the same day — which happens often enough in this business. Both need a stage riser, which again is not owned, so Stockroom raised a rental for each at ₱9,000.00. On paper this looks <i>identical</i> to the tents above: two rental requests, one item, same queue. That is exactly why a rule based on counting requests would get it wrong.	
SHOWS	Renting wins	This is the card to spend time on. Same trigger, opposite conclusion.
NUMBERS	Rent twice ₱18,000.00 · buy 2 units ₱52,000.00 · buying costs ₱34,000.00 more.	
DO THIS	Open either request. The panel is grey, not green: "Renting stays cheaper" , and there is an extra line — <i>"These requests overlap in time, so one purchased unit cannot cover them both — 2 would be needed."</i>	
SAY	"Same situation on paper — two rental requests, same item. But they're both on September 26th. A simple rule that says 'two rentals means buy it' would tell us to buy one riser here, and we'd still be short one on the day. So the system checks the dates, not just the count."	
THEN ADD	"And it stays quiet when it can't be sure. If there's no supplier quote or no recorded purchase price, it says compare manually instead of inventing a number."	
LIKELY FOLLOW-UP	"How can Accounting know the purchase price when Purchasing deals with the suppliers?" — "That's fair, and the screen actually says so. The buy figure is marked <i>indicative</i> because it comes from the price recorded on the inventory item, not from a supplier. What it does is flag the question. If someone acts on it, Purchasing raises the purchase and sources a real quote, and only then does it reach Accounting. So the estimate starts the conversation, but nobody approves money against it."	

Questions worth rehearsing

QUESTION	HOW TO ANSWER
What if they want to buy instead — how do they actually do it?	Purchasing has a Raise purchase instead button on the panel. It opens a form already filled in with the right quantity — the peak units, which is the number a person retyping it would most easily get wrong. Accounting can't raise requests (that's Purchasing's job), so on their side the button says Recommend purchase to Purchasing and writes the comparison into the return note for them.
Won't that confuse Accounting — a rental and a purchase for the same thing?	The purchase doesn't jump into their queue; it goes to Purchasing for a quote first. And once a purchase exists, the panel says so and the button disappears. If someone tries to approve the rental anyway, the approval dialog warns them in red that they'd be paying for the same need twice. It warns rather than blocks — because if the purchase gets refused on budget, approving the rental is the right call.
Does the system decide, or does the person?	The person, every time. The system compares and recommends; approving a rental still rents it. We were deliberate about that — buying equipment is a capital decision and shouldn't happen as a side effect of an approval screen.
What if departments don't update their preparation status?	Then the readiness signal is only as honest as their data, and we'd rather say that than pretend. But it degrades the right way: an event with nothing marked prepared shows as not ready and escalates. Chasing a department that hasn't updated its records is still the correct action.
How often do these run?	Every six hours, and once when the server starts. So a reminder can arrive up to six hours after its exact due moment. None of the rules depend on minute-level timing.

CLOSING LINE

So that's the four. The common thread, if there is one, is that we stopped showing people information and started giving them a decision — which event can't be loaded and who to chase, which client is about to lose their date, which account is about to be written off, and whether to rent this twice or buy it once.